

# THE AVENGERS IN THE 1960s

**THE MARVEL UNIVERSE** was only two years old when the Avengers first appeared. After creating the Fantastic Four with Jack Kirby in 1961, Stan Lee teamed up with Jack Kirby and artists Steve Ditko and Don Heck to create other super heroes like the Hulk, Spider-Man, Thor, Iron Man and Ant-Man. When the time came to launch a new title, it seemed natural to team up some of their current heroes. The Avengers weren't like any other super-team. Where the Fantastic Four was a family, the Avengers were a team of all-stars with any other ever-changing roster. The group first gathered together to fight the Hulk and then invited him to become a member. He agreed, but only stayed for one issue. Captain America joined in the fourth issue and a whole new team was introduced in Avengers #16.

The creative team also underwent changes: Stan Lee and Jack Kirby began the series, but Jack left the title's interiors after only eight issues, although he continued drawing the covers for the next few years. Artist Don Heck took over in 1964 and penciled 22 issues and an annual. He was followed by John Buscema in 1967, who did about 21 issues. Gene Colan, Barry Windsor-Smith and Sal Buscema all succeeded John, producing a few issues each. Stan Lee scripted the first 34 issues and writer Roy Thomas took up the reins in 1966 with a run that continued into the 1970s.



*The Avengers Annual #1 (Sept. 1967)  
The Mandarin gathers a squad of super-villains to take on both the original members and the new Avengers team in a story by Roy Thomas and Don Heck.  
(Cover by John Buscema and George Roussou)*



*The Avengers #63 (April 1969) Hawkeye exchanges his arrows for Hank Pym's growth serum and becomes the new Goliath. (Cover by Gene Colan and George Klein)*

*The Avengers #56 (Sept. 1968) Captain America relives the death of his partner, Bucky Barnes. (Cover by John Buscema and George Klein)*



1969



*The Avengers #71 (Dec. 1969)  
The first appearance of the Invaders. (Cover by Sal Buscema and Sam Grainger)*

1968



*The Avengers #58 (Nov. 1968)  
The Vision joins the team. (Cover by John Buscema and George Klein)*

1967



*The Avengers #43 (Aug. 1967)  
Hawkeye learns about the Black Widow's shady past. (Cover by John Buscema and George Roussou)*

1966



*The Avengers #30 (July 1966)  
The Avengers discover El Dorado. (Cover by Jack Kirby and Frank Giacoia)*

1965



*The Avengers #16 (May 1965)  
A new group of Avengers takes over the title. (Cover by Jack Kirby and Sol Brodsky)*

1964



*The Avengers #3 (Jan. 1964)  
The Hulk joins the Sub-Mariner against his former team. (Cover by Jack Kirby and Paul Reinman)*

1963



*The Avengers #1 (Sept. 1963)  
Earth's Mightiest Heroes assemble to combat Loki. (Cover by Jack Kirby and Dick Ayer)*